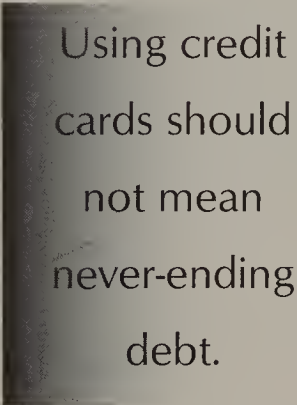


Everyday People

What about people like Jody and Richard? Richard works construction and Jody works at a daycare center. They get by, and they pay their bills. They have a two-year old, and Jody just gave birth to another baby. Their ten-year-old washing machine died, and Richard does not want Jody to have to take a toddler and a newborn to the Laundromat. Anyone who has ever had a baby knows that one tiny person creates a huge pile of laundry. Richard bought a new washer and had to charge it to his credit card.

There is Helen, a retired music teacher. Her husband handled all the bills and when he died, she was lost. They never had any children, so she does not really have anyone to look out for her, except one nephew who mows her grass and changes her light bulbs. Helen has prescription medicines that insurance and Medicare do not fully cover, and they cost her hundreds of dollars every month. She was taken advantage of by an unscrupulous contractor who charged her double for a new roof. Her car needs a new fuel pump. Helen won't get her Social Security check for a few weeks, so she had to put the car repair on her credit card.



Using credit
cards should
not mean
never-ending
debt.

Or how about Greg? His divorce cost him more than he could have ever anticipated in lawyer fees, plus he has to pay alimony and child support. His ex-wife got the house and has a very low-paying job. The water heater sprung a leak, so she called Greg to take care of it. His children need hot water to take baths, so he bought a new water heater, but he had to put it on his credit card.

These people cannot “cut out the fat.”

The trouble is that everyday working people cannot make it without having to use the credit card from time to time, and once they do, the trap snaps shut and they are ensnared in a labyrinth of fees. Getting untangled from it all seems so complicated that people can get overwhelmed or confused or scared.